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Remembering India

[The India we want]:
A new India and, ironically, the oldest India,
One with safety to walk,
One with safety to talk,
One where voices are heard,
One where stereotypes are unheard;
Maybe the 50-year-old suited journalists have forgotten India,
And perhaps the democratically chosen politicians have forgotten India,
But the youth hasn't and will not forget India.
From climate strikes, to giving voice to the voiceless, to marching on streets to know the truth, to going through the internet to garner support for the needy, to asking the right questions, to just knowing their rights and enforcing them, there is a change, and there will be one.
Visible? Yes,
Audible? Yes,
Fast? Probably not,
But comprehensive?
Damn straight. ■



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

FEARLESS NATION

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What is my dream India like? Well, it's not like I've been given a menu card of choices to pick from. Ah, a more tolerant India. What would you like with that? A side of inclusivity? Maybe a dash of free speech and fundamental rights? Well, here you go, we offer everything in our Constitution.

But whether they offer you a dash of this and a side of that, never forget to take everything with a pinch of salt. The India I've grown up in has constantly said the future is in our hands, yet our hands are tied behind our backs. When we're crossing milestones, it applauds us, but suddenly, mysteriously, we're "crossing limits", and it becomes orange-faced, spluttering with rage. (Why, I thought only a certain former US president had exclusive rights to that reaction.)

The India I dream of is one without contradictions, where what is on paper is in practice. The India I dream of lets me fly without watching over my shoulder. Where people don't laugh at sexist, homophobic jokes and look the other way at the mention of accountability. Above all, it is a home, which lets me dream of a future without fear. ■